

Nouns and verbs

Teaching guide

Choose the form that fits a sentence.

Understand the distinction

A noun can name a thing, action, or idea; a verb tells what happens or describes a state. Some words have the same spelling in both roles: a plan / we plan. Other families change form: a decision / decide.

Look at the sentence pattern. An article such as a often comes before a noun phrase. A subject often needs a verb. Endings can help, but they are not reliable rules for every word. Check an unfamiliar word in a dictionary.

Compare the patterns

NOUN

We made a decision.

Decision names the result.

VERB

We decided to wait.

Decided is the past-tense verb.

BOTH

We plan to discuss the plan.

The first plan is a verb; the second is a noun.

Read each example. Explain what the highlighted choice means in context. Then cover the example and say a similar sentence.

Check your understanding

Write before looking at the answers. The guide gives a model answer and explains the choice. Other wording can be correct.

1. We need to ___ today. (decision / decide)

2. Please make a ___ . (choice / choose)

3. Identify the verb: They work at a school.

Use it in your own life

Use one word family in two sentences.

Self-check

Does your sentence express your intended meaning? Does its form follow the relevant pattern? Can a reader understand the context?

Try again

After checking the explanation, revise your sentence. Say it aloud or use it in a short conversation.

Answers and explanation

1. decide

To is followed by the base verb in this pattern.

2. choice

A introduces a noun phrase.

3. work

Work tells what they do.

One possible response

We discussed the problem. The discussion was useful.

This is a model, not the only acceptable answer. Assess meaning, grammar, and context together.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-06.html

A practical teaching sequence

1. Notice (2 minutes)

Ask learners to explain the differences between the comparison examples before reading the rules. Use their answers to identify the point that needs attention.

2. Explain and check (4 minutes)

Read the short explanation together. Keep its qualifications: a common pattern is not necessarily a rule for every context. Ask learners to give a counterexample where the lesson mentions an exception.

3. Apply (5 minutes)

Use one word family in two sentences.

Have learners work alone, then compare with a partner. Ask the partner to restate the intended meaning before suggesting a correction.

4. Review (3 minutes)

Use the answer explanations to review the three checks. Accept natural alternatives that preserve the intended meaning. Ask each learner to revise one sentence and identify the change.

Extension

Change the person, time, place, or purpose in a comparison example. Ask whether the original pattern still fits and why. Revisit one example in the next lesson.

Feedback criteria

Meaning: the message is understandable. Form: the target pattern fits the context. Transfer: the learner can use it in a fresh example. This short activity is not a proficiency certification.